

STADIUMS OF SCALE

Pics: GETTY IMAGES

From the altitude of Mexico City to the glass-and-steel sprawl of Los Angeles, the 16 World Cup stadiums this year are not merely venues but stages that will shape how the tournament is seen and remembered. Selected from existing arenas that serve as home grounds for NFL and MSL teams in the United States and leading football clubs in Canada and Mexico, each has undergone significant upgrades to meet the magnitude of the event. The tournament will open at the Estadio Azteca and will end with the final at the MetLife Stadium.

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AT&T Stadium

Location: Arlington (Dallas), Texas, USA

Home team: Dallas Cowboys (NFL)

History: Opened in 2009, it hosted Super Bowl XLV.

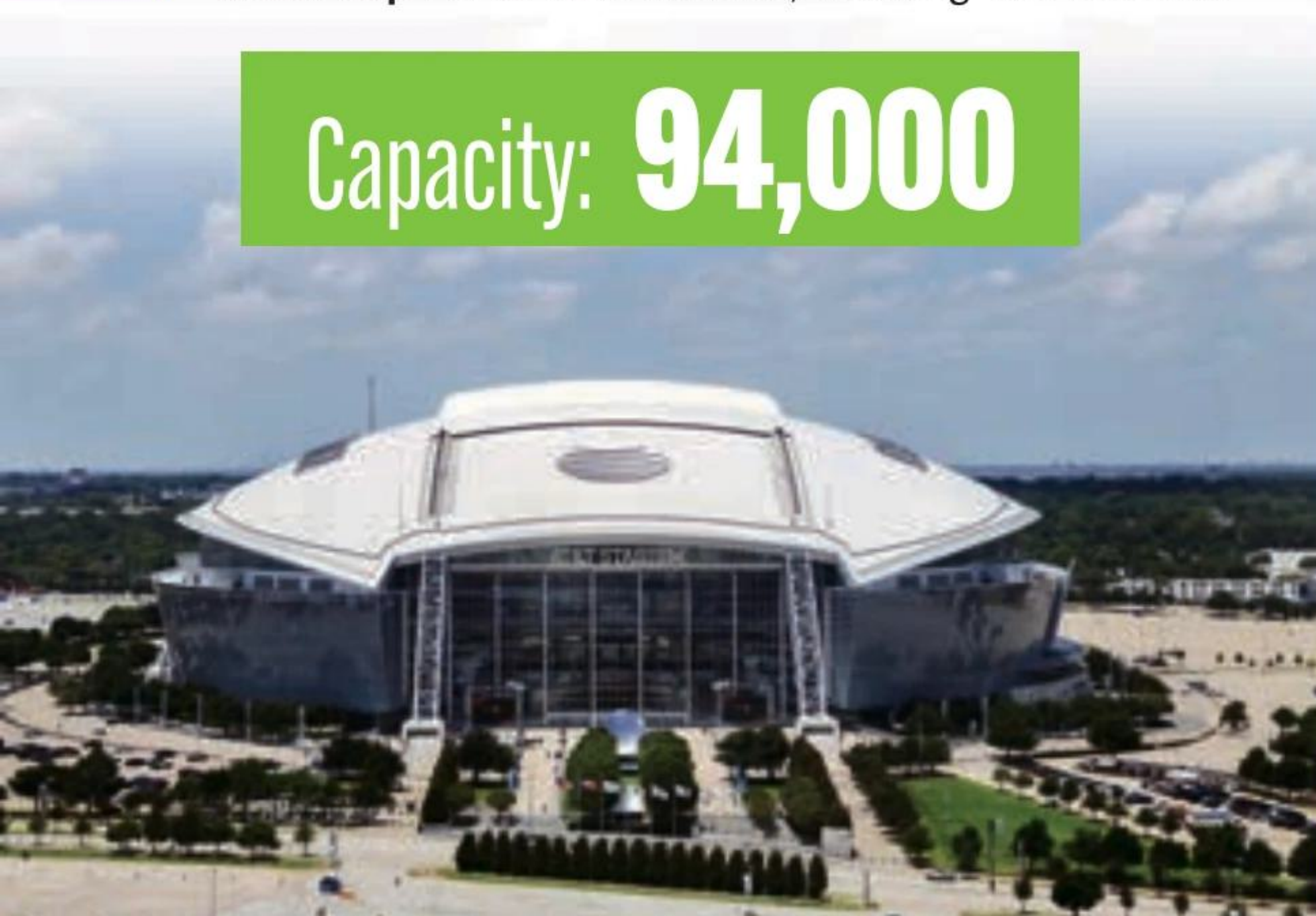
Food/Culture: A strong Texas identity defines the experience — barbecue, brisket, smoked meats, nachos, tacos and a deep-rooted sports bar culture.

Venue upgrades: The pitch will be raised above the stadium floor to achieve the required width. Portions of 12 field-level suites at the corners will be temporarily removed and reinstated ahead of the 2026 NFL season. Its retractable roof and climate-controlled interior are key features.

Weather: Despite the altitude, average highs hover around 23°C, moderated by indoor conditions.

World Cup 2026: Nine matches, including first semifinal

Capacity: **94,000**



Estadio Azteca



Capacity: **83,000**

Location: Mexico City, Mexico

Home team: Club America (Liga MX), Mexican national team

History: Opened in 1966, it hosted the 1970 and 1986 World Cup finals and will become the first stadium to stage matches in three editions. Temporarily renamed Estadio Banorte under a commercial agreement that funded renovations for 2026.

Food/Culture: The usual tacos, tortas, quesadillas and street corn, alongside expansive fan festivals.

Venue upgrades: Renovations include a hybrid pitch, expanded 90,000+ capacity and new LED lighting.

Weather: With the stadium at over 7,000 feet above sea level, pleasant evenings of 24 to 26°C to be expected.

World Cup 2026: Five matches, including opener